

Holly Lopez

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Research summary

My research bridges **computational linguistics**, **social informatics**, and **critical data studies**. I focus on **AI safety** and **fairness**, **measurement of AI harms**, **abusive language detection**, and **content moderation systems**. I develop methodologically rigorous approaches that center human judgment, account for annotator disagreement, and recognize the lived experiences of communities most impacted by harmful content and flawed moderation systems. My work addresses critical data studies, **ethical issues in machine learning**, and the development of methods for inherently **subjective natural language processing tasks**.

Skills

Programming languages

Python, R

Utilities

Scikit learn, PyTorch, Gensim, ggplot

Methodological expertise

Content analysis, instrument development, cognitive testing, inter-rater reliability analysis, corpus annotation

Education

Ph.D. Information Science

Indiana University, Bloomington

Advisor: Susan Herring

2026 (expected)

M.A. Linguistics

Georgetown University

Thesis Advisor: Dr Heidi Hamilton

Fall 2012

B.A. Communication Studies, Magna Cum Laude

Vanguard University

Spring 2008

Academic Appointments

Assistant Instructor, Instructor of Record

Indiana University, Bloomington

2021-2024 AYs

Courses: *Information Institutions and their Management (ILS Z-550)*, *Social Media Mining (ILS Z-639)*, *Content Analysis for the Web (ILS Z-642)*

Assistant Instructor, Co-Instructor

Indiana University, Bloomington

2018-2020 AYs

Courses: *Information Institutions and their Management (ILS Z-550)*, *From James Bond to Zombie Apocalypse and NSA Leaks: Evaluating Information and Intelligence (ILS Z-115)*

Professional Experience

Qualitative Research Assistant

2014 - 2017

Jeffco Public Schools, Golden, CO

- Designed and executed research studies and program evaluations for Title I funded projects including family engagement, literacy, and academic intervention initiatives.
- Developed and validated assessment instruments and surveys for program evaluation
- Facilitated design workshops in which 27 family engagement liaisons developed family outreach initiatives at Title I schools across the district.
- Led the Supplemental Education Services program in the iterative design process for three years and used mixed-methods research to inform incremental change throughout the program's life cycle.

User Experience Research Analyst

2012-2013

Fors Marsh Group LLC, Arlington, VA

- Performed and designed user experience research for web products and surveys.
- Conducted cognitive testing on research instruments to ensure reliability and validity
- Led focus group research and created reports with recommendations for the improvement of employee recruitment and retention web products for the Department of Veterans Affairs.
- Contributed to the Total Organization Health Survey product used by numerous organizations seeking data on workforce development.

Publications

Journals & Proceedings

Lopez, H. (Under Review). Combating harmful content: A critical realist review of interventions for the prevention and mitigation of online abusive language. *The Annual Review of Information Science and Technology (ARIST)*.

Lopez, H. & Kübler, S. (2025). Contextualization in abusive language annotation and corpora development [special issue]. *Discourse, Context, and Media*.

Lopez Long, H and Fichman, P. (2023). The impact of politeness on conversational outcomes in mobile dating apps. *Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences*, Lahaina, Hawaii.

Lopez Long, H., O'Neil, A., & Kübler, S. (2021). On the Interaction between Annotation Quality and Classifier Performance in Abusive Language Detection. *Proceedings of the International Conference on Recent Advances in Natural Language Processing (RANLP 2021)*.

Herring, S. C., Dainas, A. R., & Lopez Long, H. (2020). If I'm close with them it wouldn't be weird": Social distance and animoji use. *International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction*. Springer, Cham.

Herring, S. C., Dainas, A. R., Lopez Long, H., & Tang, Y. (2020). Animoji adoption and use: Gender associations with an emergent technology. *Proceedings of Emoji 2020*. CA: AAAI.

Herring, S. C., Dainas, A. R., Lopez Long, H., & Tang, Y. (2020). Animoji Performances. *Language@Internet*, 18(1).

Invited Talks

Lopez Long, H. (2021). Data quality in abusive language data sets and the ethics of developing corpora. Invited talk. Digital Language Variation in Context (DiLCo): Ethics Workshop.

Lopez Long, H. (2019). Integrating discourse perspectives and computational approaches. Invited Talk. University of Hamburg Germany: Digital Language Workshop.

Conference Presentations

Lopez Long, H., O'Neil, A., & Kübler, S. (2022). Annotating fine-grained categories for abusive and non-abusive data: Beyond binary decisions. Sociolinguistics Symposium, Ghent, Belgium.

Lopez Long, H. (2012). Tweeting to the choir: Stance-taking and positioning of religious authority online. 57th *Annual International Linguistics Association Conference*, New York City, NY.

Awards

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering Outstanding Teaching	2023 & 2024
Anti-Defamation League, Center for Technology and Society Fellowship	2023
Luddy PhD Summer Research Award	2023
Information Science Leadership Fellowship	2018

Service and professional activities

Journal & proceedings reviewer

- Conference on Natural Language Processing/Konferenz zur Verarbeitung Natürlicher Sprache (KOVENS)
- Language@Internet
- European Conference on Information Systems (ECIS)
- Workshop on Online Abuse and Harms (WOAH)

University service

- Information and Library Science Doctoral Research Forum student committee
- Information and Library Science Doctoral Student Association committee member
- Graduate & Professional Student Government Research Award reviewer

Memberships

- Member, Digital Language in Context (DiLCo) Research Network (2019-2022)
International network based at Universität Hamburg - Invited speaker at DiLCo Ethics Workshop (2021)
- Member, Association of Information Science and Technology (ASIST) (2021-present)